

THE MOTION

This House Believes that

India should move from a culture of familial obligation towards one of individual autonomy

MARK WHERE YOU STAND, NOW AND ON THE WAY OUT THE FAMILY DECIDES ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ YOU DECIDE

WHAT THE WORDS MEAN

FAMILIAL OBLIGATION

The social, cultural and moral expectation that you put your family's needs and expectations first in an important decision. Care of parents, money, marriage, career, the family's name.

INDIVIDUAL AUTONOMY

The freedom to make those same decisions by your own values and aspirations, without undue outside pressure. Career, partner, where you live, what you believe, what you do with your money.

MOVE TOWARDS

A shift in the balance, not a replacement. Nobody is proposing that family stops mattering. The motion asks which way the weight should sit.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

BOTH SIDES AGREE

Family matters, and so does the freedom to choose your own life. Neither side is arguing to abolish either, and both accept that every culture strikes some balance between them.

THEY SPLIT ON

Is the balance India strikes about right, or does it weigh family so heavily that individuals pay for it in the lives they end up living?

WHERE EACH SIDE STARTS

FOR THE MOTION

The weight sits too far on the family. People pay for it in careers, partners and cities they did not choose, and the culture should move.

AGAINST

The balance is not broken. Obligation is what makes families hold, and moving towards autonomy trades real security for individual preference.

TAKING THE FLOOR

- 1 Write it down before you raise your hand. If it does not fit in one sentence, it is not ready.
- 2 One question at a time, put to the room and not to one person. If you have several, pick the best.
- 3 Sharp and specific. The best questions are not opinions in disguise. They are ones the other side has to answer.
- 4 No anecdotes. We are stress-testing arguments, not swapping experiences. If it opens with "I once knew someone who", hold it.
- 5 A warning at sixty seconds, a hard cutoff at ninety. The buzzer is not a suggestion.

WRITE IT DOWN FIRST

Draft while you listen. One sentence each, and if it does not fit on the line it is not ready.

1

2

THE ONE YOU WILL ASK

Pick the best of them. One question, put to the room.